

SEAG-style practice tests

the catapult papers

A stylized illustration of a person with dark hair and sunglasses sitting in a catapult. The catapult is grey and has two long arms that curve upwards. The person is holding onto the ends of these arms. The catapult is mounted on a base with four legs, each ending in a large, black, treaded wheel. A red banner with white text is draped across the middle of the catapult.

the warm-up series

Name: _____

Score: _____

Warm-Up 3

2026 edition

Notes for parents

The Warm-Up Series of The Catapult Papers introduces children to the Transfer Test process in a gentle and accessible way. These papers are intended for P6 pupils and reflect the stage at which schools typically begin early preparation, around eight months before the official exams. At this point in the school year, some relevant English and Maths skills will not yet have been covered in class. Although a small number of these concepts may appear within the Warm-Up papers, the overall difficulty level has been moderated to provide a first, confidence-building look at SEAG-style questions.

As children progress through the Warm-Up Series, they will gradually become familiar with the structure, pacing, and style of SEAG assessments. Completion of this series should help prepare them for the more challenging papers within the main Catapult Papers series (20 papers), which continue the progression toward full P7 readiness.

The official time limit for the Transfer Test is 60 minutes. However, because this is a practice paper, no time limit is printed. Parents may decide how long to allow for completion, depending on their child's needs and stage of learning.

This test paper may be written on, but answers must be recorded on the separate answer sheet provided. Guidance on how to do this is included at the top of that page. An answers page has also been provided for marking. Each correct answer is awarded one mark, and no question is worth more than one mark. Half-marks are not recommended. In the English section, misspelled answers should only be accepted when spelling is not part of the skill being tested. When spelling accuracy is central to the question (e.g. plurals, verb endings), the response should be marked incorrect if spelled wrongly.

Spaces for recording the final score are provided on both the cover page and the answer sheet. Parents may record the result either as a percentage or as a score out of 56.

Finally, please remember that these are practice tests. Early scores are not an indication of eventual performance. At this stage, the purpose of the Warm-Up Series is to build familiarity, develop confidence, and introduce children gradually to the range of skills and question types they will meet later in the Transfer Test journey.

Permission to use this paper is granted for one child only. No photocopying or sharing of the test is permitted. A separate series of The Catapult Papers is available exclusively for schools.

English

In this exercise there are some mistakes with **punctuation** or use of **capital letters**. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**. If there is **no** mistake, mark **N**.

Punctuation Exercise

1 'He hasn't much chance of success. He can't dance act or sing!' observed Bob.

A B C D

2 It was a cold, wet night in Bristol; the city's streets were completely empty

A B C D

3 Wednesday's were the worst: there'd always be cauliflower cheese for dinner.

A B C D

4 Grace was immensely proud of her brothers achievements, and gave him a hug.

A B C D

5 If you had just put it back where you found it,' Dad replied, 'then we wouldn't
be having this discussion.'

A B C D

In this exercise you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that the sentences make sense and are written in correct English. Choose the best answer and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**.

Grammar Exercise

6 'There is no name at the top of the page, so I can't tell who whos who's
A B C
whom whose work it is.'
D E

7 It would be up to either Mia with or and neither nor Leo to break
A B C D E
the bad news to everyone.

8 It was a terrible incredibly remarkably certainly warm hot day
A B C D E
in the city of Houston.

9 Charles stubbornly insisted at to for upon by taking the front
A B C D E
passenger seat of the car.

10 I'll meet you where at in when on the river bends and the trees
A B C D E
start to thin.

In this exercise there are some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. If there is no mistake, mark N.

Spelling Exercise

11 Our only requirment is that you produce a copy of your driving licence.
A B C D

12 'In a moment, we will learn how to convert millimetres into centimetres.'
A B C D

13 'That was an extremely irresponsible thing for you to say to your friends, Jake.'
A B C D

14 Olivia wood often forget to rule margins in her English homework book.
A B C D

15 The bed and breakfast was set in the most gloriously old-fashioned
cottage imaginable.
A B C D

Read the whole poem carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

The Shades of Sherwood

1. Beneath Sherwood's ancient umbrella,
2. where trees stand as guardians,
3. their remaining leaves a scattered tapestry of green,
4. we walk in the silence of nature's sanctuary.

5. The forest floor, a field of fallen foliage,
6. scrunching softly beneath our synchronised steps,
7. each noise absorbed by the majesty
8. of Sherwood's timeless embrace.

9. Glimmers of sunlight filter through the leaves,
10. creating a mosaic of light and shadow,
11. a dance of illumination on the earth,
12. as if the very air is alive with stories.

13. In the hush of the woodland, whispers linger,
14. echoes of legends and tales untold,
15. secrets woven into the fabric of the trees,
16. where Robin Hood and his band once roamed.

17. No scheduled path guides our way,
18. only the wandering trails of the forest,
19. each turn revealing a new scene,
20. a canvas painted with the shades of Sherwood.

21. I turn to my son, his eyes wide with wonder,
22. a reflection of sunlight in the innocence of youth,
23. and in the silence, a conversation begins,
24. words spoken in the language of rustling leaves.

25. 'Dad,' he says, 'what'll school be like tomorrow?'
26. His voice, a gentle ripple in the forest's quiet stream,
27. but the trees, wise listeners, absorb his concerns,
28. and I reply, 'It'll be a place of learning, Son.'

29. The forest, a teacher in its own right,
30. the rustle of leaves a lesson in the art of letting go,
31. as worries disperse like morning mist,
32. and the weight of workbooks feels lighter than air.
33. We walk on, the conversation shifting,
34. from lessons and homework to dreams and desires,
35. the forest, a companion in our shared journey,
36. its presence is a medicine for the concerns of the day.
37. Sherwood, an ancient mystery,
38. a hideaway for fathers and sons to bond,
39. where the heart finds comfort
40. in the silent poetry of the untamed.
41. As we emerge from the woodland's embrace,
42. the world outside, with all its noise and haste,
43. feels a bit softer, a bit kinder,
44. thanks to the lessons learned in Sherwood's shade.
-

Please answer these questions. (Look at the poem again if you need to.)
You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

16

Which of the following statements describes the rhyming pattern of this poem?

- A** The poem does not have a rhyming pattern.
- B** In each verse, the final words on odd-numbered lines rhyme with each other.
- C** In each verse, the final words on even-numbered lines rhyme with each other.
- D** In each verse, the final words on all four lines rhyme with each other.
- E** Only the fifth verse contains a rhyming pattern.

17

Which of the following words best summarises the mood of the poem?

- A haunting
- B chaotic
- C humorous
- D peaceful
- E noisy

18

Which two lines in the poem contain examples of alliteration?

- A lines 1 & 2
- B lines 3 & 4
- C lines 5 & 6
- D lines 7 & 8
- E lines 9 & 10

19

Look at lines 17 - 20. Which of the following statements describes why the father and son are walking through the forest?

- A They are looking for a picnic table.
- B Taking a path through the forest is a shortcut to the son's school.
- C The son needs to visit the forest because of a school project.
- D The father is teaching the son about Robin Hood.
- E They are simply going for a walk, and do not seem to mind which path they take.

20

Which of the following words from the poem is similar in meaning to 'wild'?

- A companion (line 35)
- B medicine (line 36)
- C mystery (line 37)
- D comfort (line 39)
- E untamed (line 40)

21

‘...thanks to the lessons learned in Sherwood’s shade (line 44)

Which of the following statements best describes the main lesson that the son learned during the forest journey?

- A The forest will provide all of the answers to his schoolwork.
- B He must take time to forget his concerns, and enjoy nature instead.
- C It is important to show kindness to others.
- D He should do his homework in the forest.
- E School is unnecessary.

22

Which one part of speech is ‘beneath’ (line 1)?

- A noun
- B adjective
- C verb
- D adverb
- E preposition

For these questions you have to **write your answers**, neatly, in the boxes provided on your answer sheet.

23

Look at lines 1 - 4. Which one word is closest in meaning to ‘safe place’?

24

Look at lines 29 - 32. Which of these lines contains a simile?
Write the number of the line.

25

Which three-word phrase in lines 25 - 28 tells us that the forest ‘soaks up the son’s worries’?

26

According to the poem, what creates ‘a mosaic of light and shadow’?

27

The words 'softer' and 'kinder' (line 43) are known as comparative adjectives. They are created from the adjectives 'soft' and 'kind'.

What comparative adjective is created from the word 'happy'?

28

Which one part of speech are the following as they appear in the passage?

silence (line 4), **steps** (line 6), **whispers** (line 13), **canvas** (line 20)

Maths

29

A taxi arrived in Portrush at 20:05. Its journey had started in Lisburn 1 hour and 40 minutes before this.

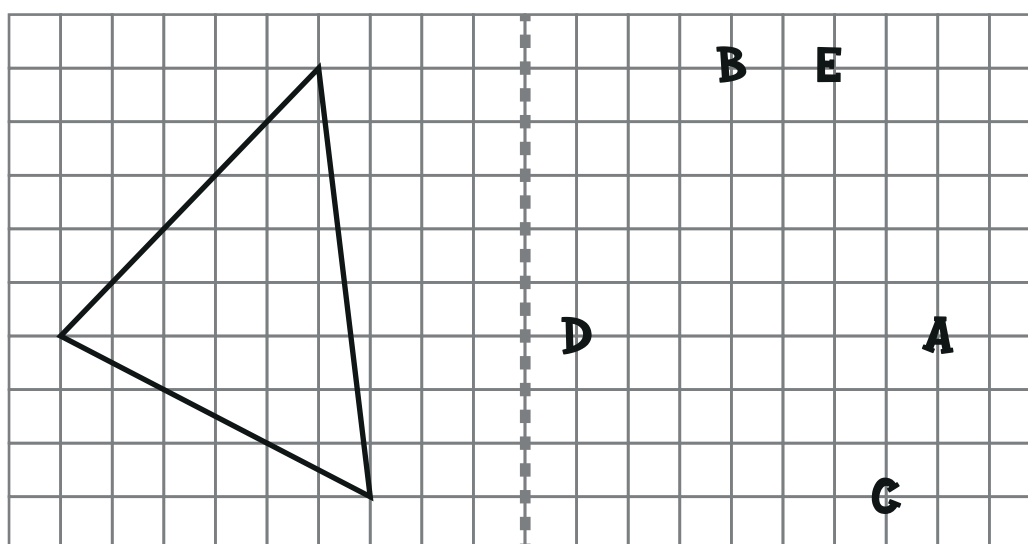
At what time did the taxi leave Lisburn?

A 7.20 pm **B** 6.25 pm **C** 8.25 pm **D** 6.20 pm **E** 7.25 pm

.....

30

The triangle on this grid has to be reflected through a vertical line.



Which of the five points to the right of the reflection line would reflect one corner of the triangle?

- A** Point A
- B** Point B
- C** Point C
- D** Point D
- E** Point E

31

A Year 4 class was asked to count the plastic shapes inside one of the classroom containers. They recorded their results in this tally chart.

Shape	Tally
Circle	
Semi-circle	
Square	
Rectangle	
Triangle	

What percentage of the shapes in the container were circles?

A 10% B 12% C 20% D 24% E 25%

32

There are 24 rows of six seats on an airplane.



How many seats are there altogether on the airplane?

A 4 B 18 C 30 D 104 E 144

33

The sand that falls inside an egg timer is designed to last for five minutes.

How many seconds have passed when $\frac{1}{10}$ of the sand have fallen through the egg timer?

- A** 90 seconds
 - B** 225 seconds
 - C** 270 seconds
 - D** 290 seconds
 - E** 450 seconds
-

34

What is the answer to 4 divided by 100?

- A** 0.04
 - B** 0.25
 - C** 0.4
 - D** 2.5
 - E** 25
-

35

If numbers are 'consecutive', they follow one after the other, in order. For example, 4 and 5 are consecutive numbers.

The sum of two consecutive numbers is 23.

What is the product of these two numbers?

- A** 22
- B** 120
- C** 112
- D** 132
- E** 130

36

A small bag of crisps weighs 25g. A large bag of crisps weighs 65g.

Which of the following has the heaviest weight?

- A 8 small bags of crisps
 - B 4 large bags of crisps
 - C 4 small bags of crisps & 2 large bags of crisps
 - D 1 small bag of crisps & 3 large bags of crisps
 - E 5 small bags of crisps & 1 large bag of crisps
-

37

How many factors does the number 24 have?

- A 2 B 3 C 4 D 6 E 8
-

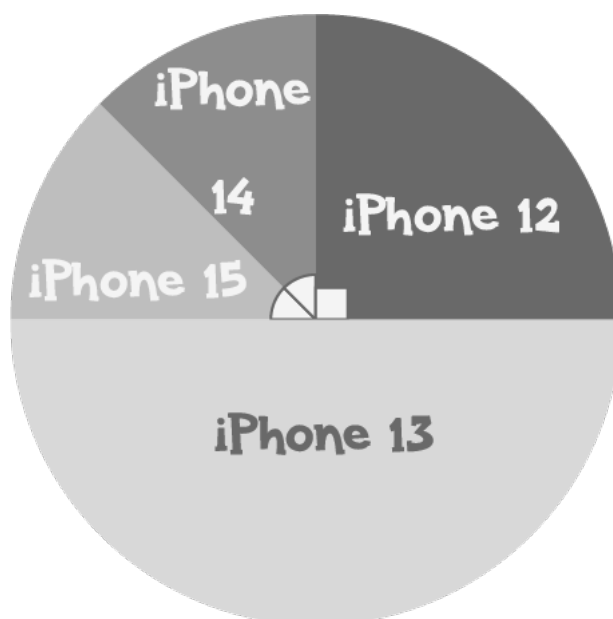
38

Which of the following statements about kites is true?

- A Kites always have just one line of symmetry.
 - B Some kites can have two lines of symmetry.
 - C Kites cannot contain any right angles.
 - D A kite can have sides that are parallel to each other.
 - E Kites can have four sides of equal length.
-

39

72 iPhone users were asked which model of iPhone they had. The results were recorded in this pie chart.



The size of the angle for the section of the pie chart labelled iPhone 15 is 45° .

How many iPhone users had an iPhone 15?

- A 9 iPhone users
- B 18 iPhone users
- C 27 iPhone users
- D 54 iPhone users
- E 63 iPhone users

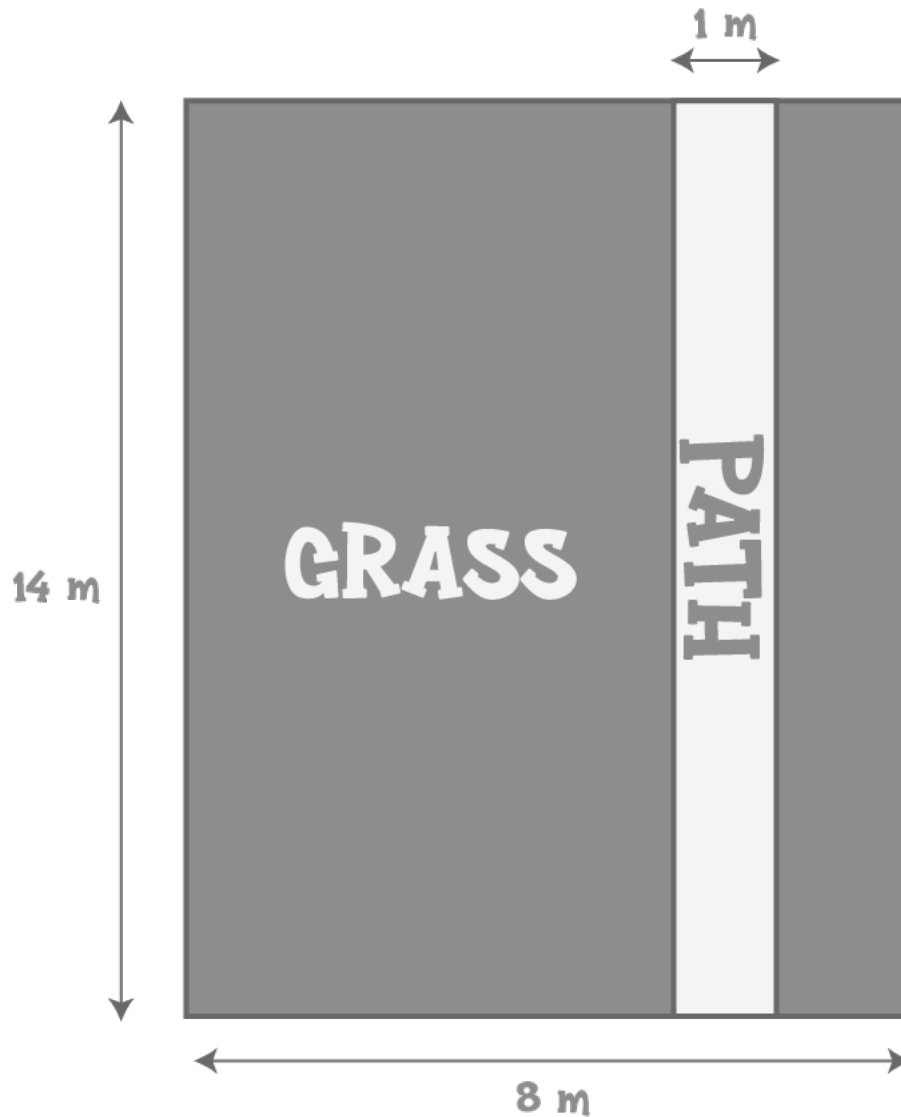
40

Poppy is facing east. She then turns a quarter-turn clockwise.

In which direction is Poppy now facing?

- A southeast B north C northwest D south E southwest

41



A rectangular garden is covered with grass, apart from a path that runs across it.

What area of the garden is covered with grass?

- A** 44 m² **B** 43 m² **C** 98 m² **D** 112 m² **E** 72 m²
-

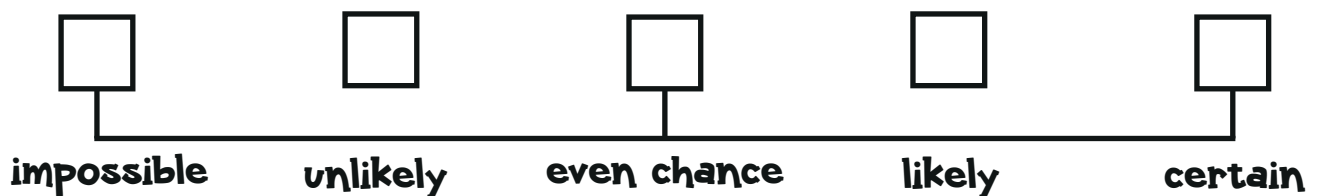
42



A six-sided dice is rolled. Look at the five possible outcomes below.

A	A square number is rolled.
B	A number less than 0.75 is rolled.
C	A factor of 12 is rolled.
D	A number greater than 0.75 is rolled.
E	An odd number is rolled.

These five outcomes must be placed on the probability line below.



Going from left to right, what will the order of letters be on the probability line?

- A** A, B, C, D, E
 - B** D, C, E, A, B
 - C** B, E, A, C, D
 - D** B, C, E, A, D
 - E** B, A, E, C, D
-

43

Which of the following measurements is the same as 0.06 kilometres?

- A 0.6 m B 6 m C 60 m D 600 m E 6000 m
-

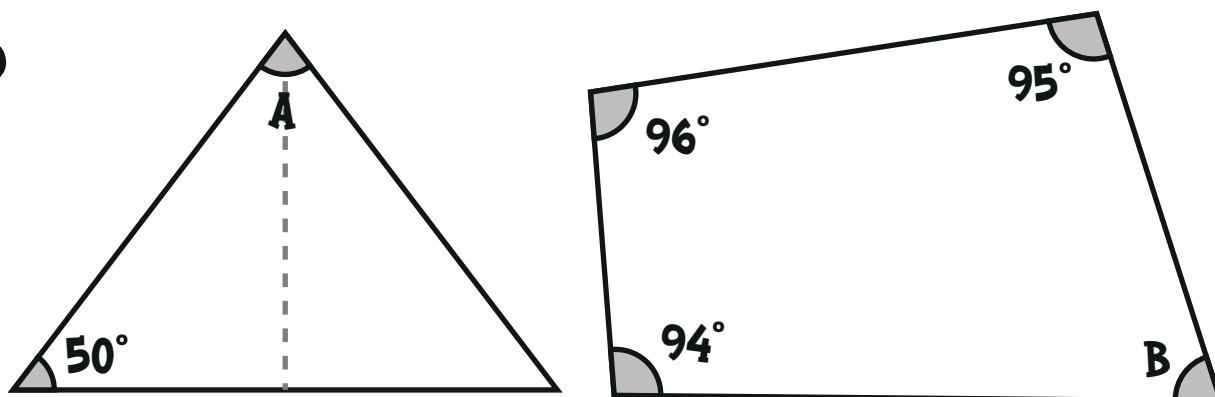
44

402.785

Which of the digits above is in the hundredths place?

- A 4 B 2 C 7 D 8 E 5
-

45

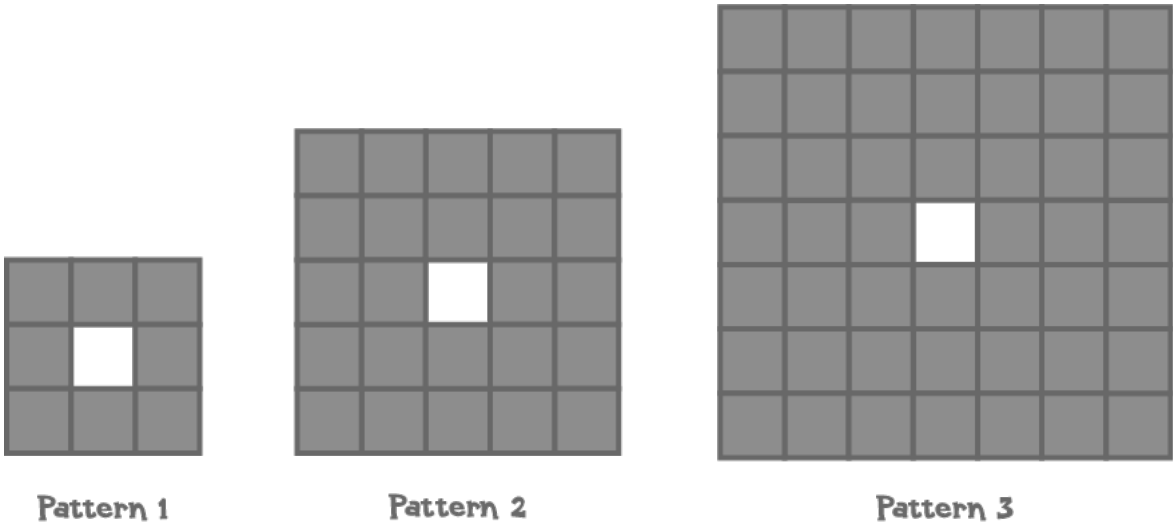


The line of symmetry is showing in the isosceles triangle.

What is the difference in size between Angle A in the isosceles triangle and Angle B in the quadrilateral?

- A 5° B 15° C 25° D 80° E 155°
-

46

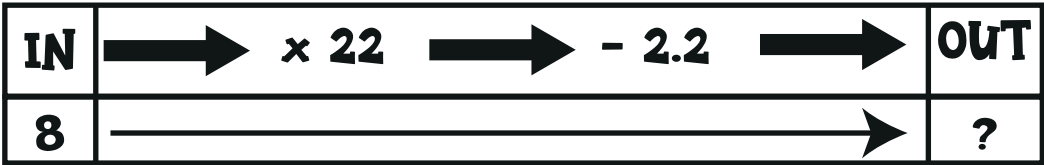


The number of shaded squares in each pattern is increasing.

How many shaded squares will there be in Pattern 4?

- A 63 squares
- B 64 squares
- C 80 squares
- D 81 squares
- E 99 squares

47



What number would come out of this function machine?

- A 154
- B 165.8
- C 174.8
- D 173.8
- E 166.8

48

Which of the following numbers is largest?

- A 18.6 B 18.59 C 18.526 D 18.099 E 18.3
-

49

The distance to Saintfield is $\frac{3}{4}$ of the distance to Dundrum.

What is the distance to Saintfield?

- A 4 km B 12 km C 15.25 km D 21.2 km E 28 km
-

50

Two numbers have a sum of 2861.
One of the numbers is 979.

What is the other number?

- A 1882 B 1898 C 1922 D 2118 E 3840
-

For questions 51 - 56, you have to **write your answers** in the boxes provided on your answer sheet. The units of measurement have been given.

51

This table shows the amounts of money saved by five children.

Becky	£34
Tori	£40
Henry	£32
Alba	£41
Toby	£48

What is the range of these amounts of money?

.....

52

Mr Harberton is charged £65 per month for his electricity at home.

How much does Mr Harberton pay for electricity in one quarter of a year?

.....

53**London - Birmingham Train Timetable**

London	0800	1030	1330	1500
Watford	0820	1050	1355	1520
Milton Keynes	0845	1115	1420	1550
Coventry	0930	1205	1505	1640
Stafford	1025	1300	1605	1740
Birmingham	1050	1330	1640	1810

Jamie lives in Coventry. It takes him 25 minutes to walk from his house to the platform at Coventry train station.

One afternoon, he leaves his house at 2.30 pm to walk to the station.

For how many minutes does Jamie have to wait at the platform until the next train to Birmingham comes along?

54

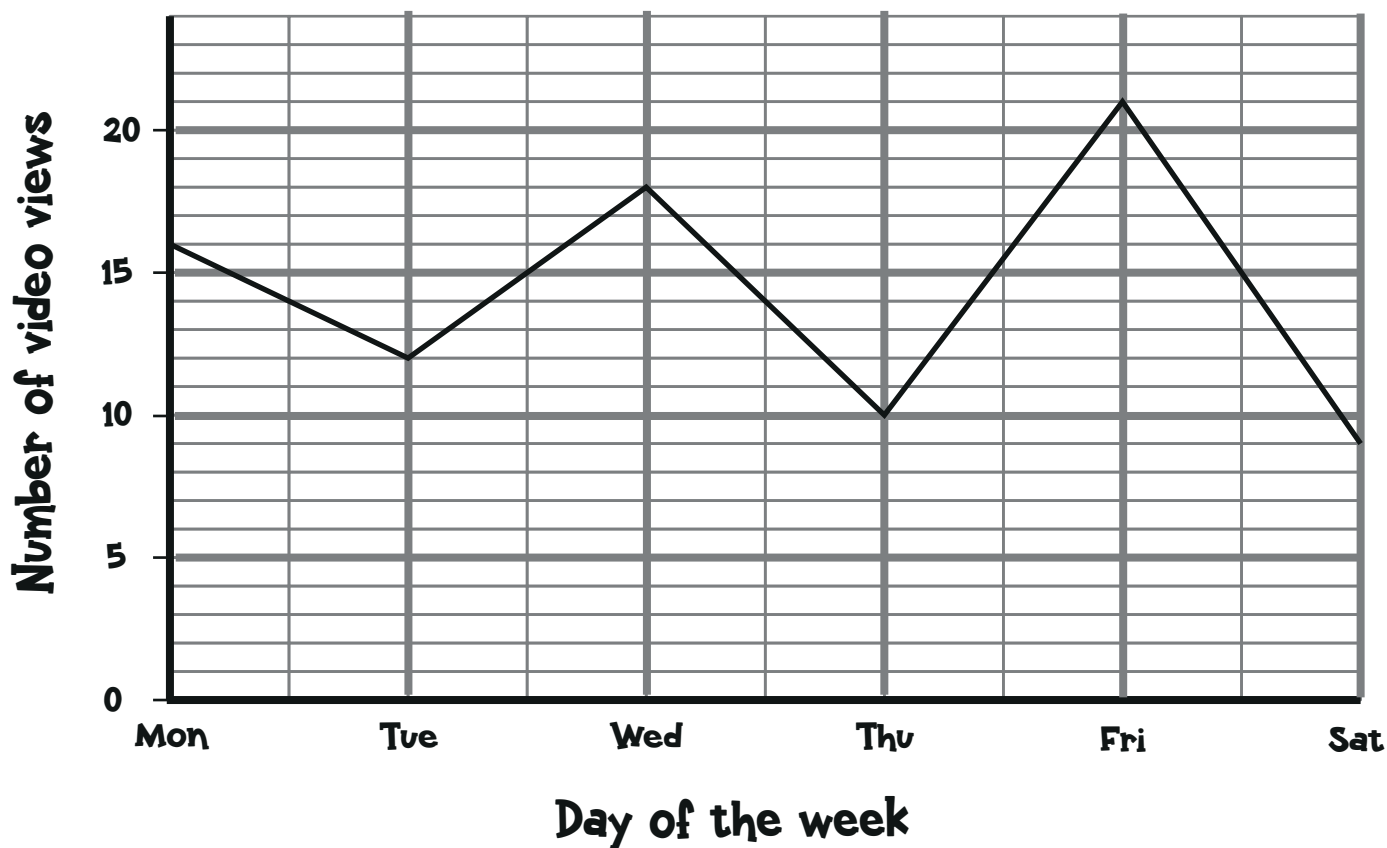
$a - 28 = 15$
$28 + b = 51$
$c^2 = 81$

What is the sum of a, b and c?

55

This line graph shows the number of viewers who watched a YouTube video during one week.

Video Views



What is the combined total of video views on Wednesday, Thursday and Friday?

56

In a class of 36 pupils, $\frac{1}{3}$ come to school by car, $\frac{2}{9}$ come to school by bus, and the rest walk to school.

How many of the pupils in this class walk to school?

The Catapultalogue



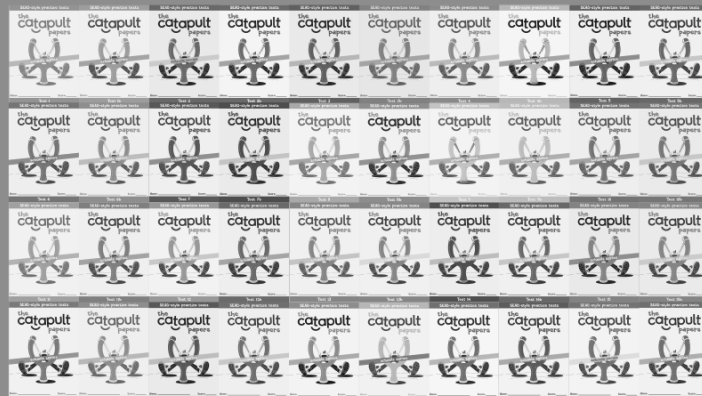
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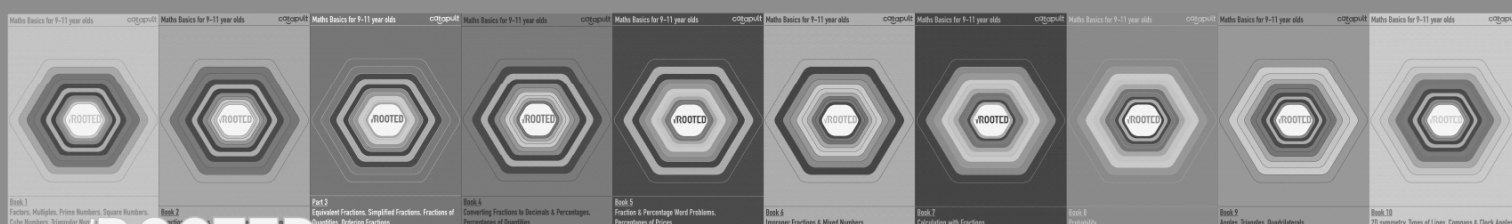
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Catapult is a one-man tuition service. Based in East Belfast, Trevor Veale has been working with primary pupils from 4 to 11-years-old on a full-time basis since 2019.

A former Year 3 and Year 6 teacher, Trevor is now fully booked as a private tutor through to the end of 2030. His teaching resources not only include *The Catapult Papers*, but also *Target Practice* and *Rooted*. All of these materials can be purchased at www.catapult-tuition.com